You Tell Me How to be a Girl in 2010

By Eve Ensler

INTRODUCTION

Women are subjected to many stereotypes in today's society. Movies and television shows suggest that all women are air-heads. Magazine and other advertisements push photographs of very slender and "sexy" women into the minds of children. Men's magazines write articles on how to "dupe" a girl into sleeping with them. Haven't we, as a society moved past the sexist ideals of the past? Judging from the way the media portrays women, it seems as if things are only getting worse. Television and movies shows tend to stereotype women (One of the most common ways television depicts teenage girls, especially, is as a dumb, ditzy girl with a credit card. The girl's interests are usually limited to make-up, boys, clothing and shopping. Movies such as Clueless, Legally Blonde, and other such movies encourage the idea that teenage girls and women are ditzy, stupid, and superficial. I deny all of these stereotypes, but You Tell me How to be a Girl in 2010 by Eve Ensler.

Questions, doubt, ambiguity, and dissent

have somehow become very un-masculine.

Authoritarian maniacs are

premiers, czars, and presidents.

4NG Fanatics

Each one is more righteous than the next.

Each town they bomb

each human they kill

is done for "humanitarian" purposes.

People don't own the water in their own village

and they certainly don't own the diamonds and gold.

Millions are forced to make dinner out of garbage and dust

while Russian businessmen and movie stars

are buying 500-million-euro villas on C'te Sud.

Bees have stopped making honey.

People are drilling in all the wrong places.

The U.S., Russia, Canada, Denmark, and Norway all claim the Arctic

but none of them seem to care that the polar bears are drowning.

They are fingerprinting, photographing our licenses and teeth.

Big Brother is now in our phones, our pods, our PCs.

Not one of us feels even a little safer.

New Age mental health providers turn

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

out to be former war torturers with beards.
And the pope in a dress showing off his
ermine trim and cuffs
is telling everyone that
people kissing people they love is the greatest evil.
A woman running for U.S. vice president
believes in creationism
but not global warming.
Why is everyone so much more afraid of sex
than SCUD missiles?
And who decided God wasn't into pleasure?
And if the hetero nuclear family is so great
how come everyone is fleeing it
or paying their life savings just
to sit in a room with a stranger and cry about it?
The Iraq war cost nearly $3 trillion.
I can't even count that high
but I know
that money could have
would have
ended poverty in general

4NG Fanatics

which would have canceled terrorism.
How come we have money to kill
but no money to feed or heal?
How come we have money to destroy
but no money for art and schools?
The fundamentalists now have
billion-dollar private armies.
The Taliban is back
but never went away.
Women are burned, raped, bludgeoned, sold,
starved, and buried alive
and still don't know they are the majority.
Water is clearly nearly running out
but even in the desert where there's serious drought
the golf courses are green and lush
and the swimming pools are full of water
for the twelve rich people who might decide to come.
Special people adopt hand-picked babies in faraway
lands.
Their flights there cost more
than the babies' parents made

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

this year.
Why don't they just give it to them?
Slavery is back
but never went away.
Just ask anyone who's been whipped
how deep the legacy.
Six million dead in the Congo
and they never made the news,
and don't tell me it doesn't have
to do with color
and minerals.
Poor folks are dying first
From hurricanes
Shame
Tsunamis
Radiation
Pollution
Floods
And neglect.
Rich folks
just put up fancier super-electrified gates

4NG Fanatics

on their private perfect cities.
Everyone's having "benefits"
and throwing fancy parties
with lots of swag
so the rich people feel good about giving
away the tiny little bit of the whole lot they have.
But no one really wants to change anything.
If you really want it
you have to give something up
like everything
and then those that have, wouldn't,
and then who would they be?
And that's too complicated
so they write checks
and keep doing the same old things.
Selling change.
Making revolution profitable.
Corporations own everything anyway
even our hippie jeans, memory cells, and rain.
Why do so many women leaders look like Margaret
Thatcher

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

and act even meaner?
Why doesn't anyone remember anything?
And how come rich bad people
get paid lots of money to give speeches
and poor bad people are tortured
and in prisons?
Is there anyone in charge?
Or is this whole thing spinning out until it explodes
or dissolves?
And if there is something we can do
why aren't we doing it?
What happened to fury?
What happened to accuracy
or accountability?
What happened to not showing off your wealth?
What happened to kindness?
What happened to teenagers rebelling
instead of buying and selling?
What happened to teenagers kissing
instead of blogging and dissing?
What happened to teenagers marching

4NG Fanatics

and refusing
instead of exploiting and using?
I want to touch you in real time
not find you on YouTube,
I want to walk next to you in the mountains
not friend you on Facebook.
Give me one thing I can believe in
that isn't a brand name.
I'm lonely.
I'm scared.
Girls younger than me are giving blowjobs
in homeroom
and they don't even know it's sex.
They just want to be popular
and get some respect.
Most girls my age are taking pills
or not getting out of bed
or eating or starving
or getting nose jobs or implants
or getting cut
or twittering away

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

or covering themselves

or desperate for a way

to be awake without faking

to be alive without freaking

to be serious

to be true

to even think of loving someone

when we're already doomed.

You tell me how to be a girl in 2010

I say let's go for it

if it's all coming down.

I say let's speak it

let's fight it

let's right it

there's nothing to hold on to

if it's already gone.

They left it to us.

It sucks but it's true.

It's you and me baby.

4NG Fanatics

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Even Ensler
Book: I am an Emotional Creature
ISBN: 978-1400061044
Publisher: Random House
Date (Month/Year): 2010

AWARD HISTORY

2010 National Qualifier – Poetry
2011 National Qualifier - Poetry

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY